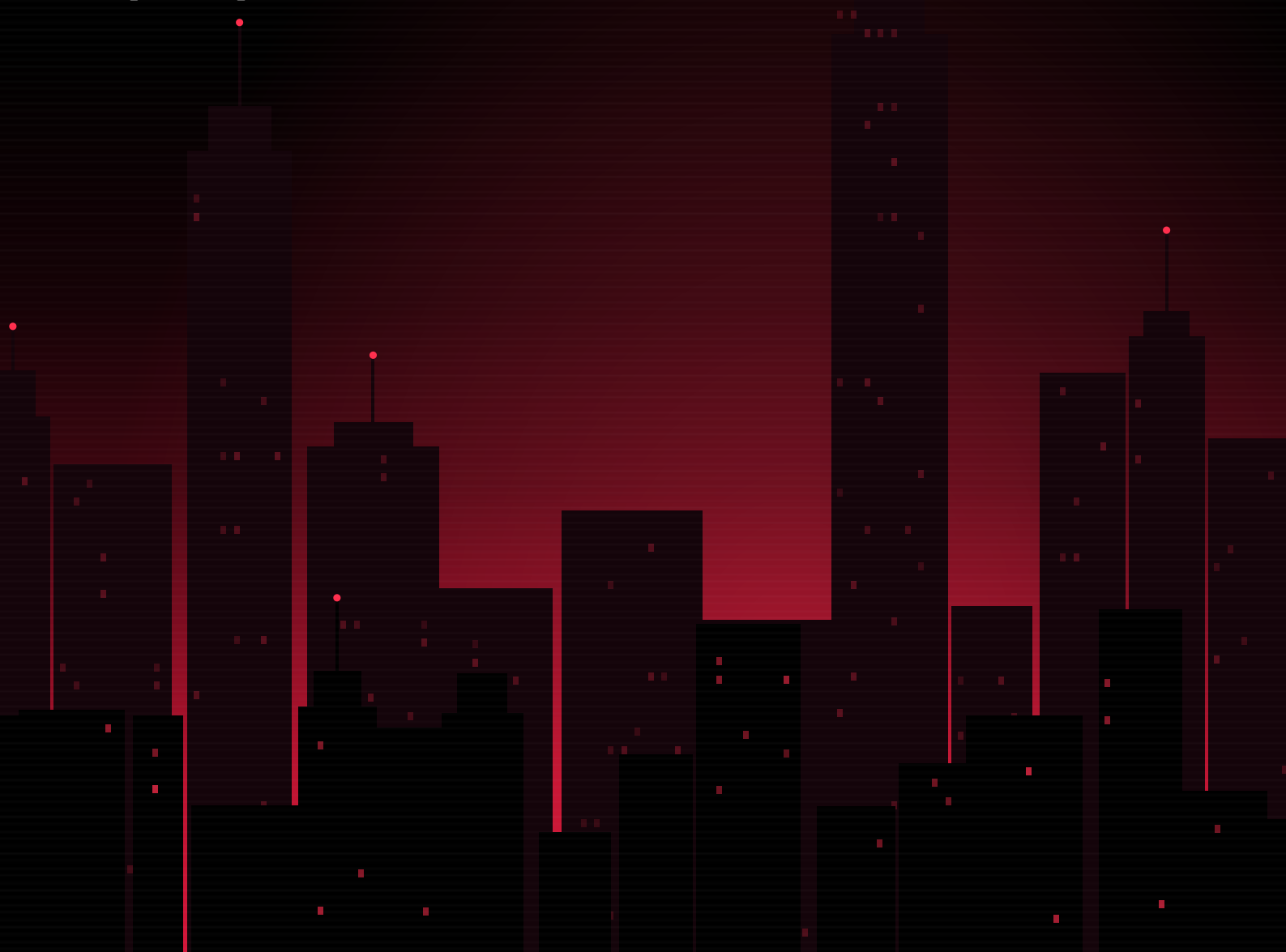
Ace's Guide to Making

JOBS & MISSIONS

A Gamemaster's Guide for use with Cyberpunk RED

by AceMageddon



Contents

01	**Structuring the Game** Street Arcs, Mission Arcs, Recommended In-Game Day Length of Missions or Downtime after Jobs and Missions, 6 Ways of Making Jobs/Missions Related to the Edgerunner(-s), Structuring Your Jobs/Missions	03
02	**Structuring the Opposition of Jobs and Missions**	05
03	**Structuring the Difficulty of Jobs** Easy Job, Typical Job, Dangerous Job	06
04	**Structuring the Difficulty of Missions** Single-Target Missions, “Room” Missions, Easy Mission, Typical Mission, Dangerous Mission	07
05	**The “Big Leagues” Difficulty** What Does It Offer?	10
06	**Structuring the Opposition for the Netrunner in Jobs/Missions** Determine the Difficulty, Determine the Floor Number, When to Throw a Demon, When to Throw an Enemy Netrunner	10
07	**How to Make Fun NPCs** Making Descriptions for NPCs, Making NPC Sheets, About Gear and Cyberware, Roles for NPCs and What to Do with Them, Base Facedown for Each NPC Type	11
08	**Promotions** Promotion Number, How and to Whom to Give Promotions, How and When to Give NPCs Promotions, How to Spend Promotions	15
09	**Structuring Boss Fights and/or Cyberpsychos** Empathy of 0 or Greater, Extreme Cyberpsychosis, Raging Extreme Cyberpsychosis	17
A	**Abbreviations & Sources** Sources Referenced	20

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01 Structuring the Game

When making a long-running Cyberpunk Campaign, it is important to have some "baseline" you can rely on when making long-running "Arcs" that span the in-game time and have some sort of narrative connection between them.

Although a Prologue/Epilogue is better made as a simple Easy/Typical Job (we'll talk about these later), it is important to realize how you're going to structure your following arcs.

There are two types of Arc Structures:

1. **Street Arc**
2. **Mission Arc**

Street Arcs

Street Arcs consist of X Gigs that are spaced 1d6 days apart (or 1d6+7 days, if your group's PCs need more downtime), where X is equal to the number of Players in your group + 1 (meaning that if you have 4 players in your group, your Street Arc consists of 5 Gigs).

Each Gig has to be relevant to at least 1 Player Character in the group (preferably to 1 PC in a major way and maybe to 1 PC in a minor way). That way, you can explore your PC's personal life and make the game feel much more "immersive" to their presence in the world.

It is better to make half of the Gigs in this arc (rounded up) somehow relevant to the final Gig of said arc, in order to give some narrative cohesion to the players' actions. The other half (rounded down) would later serve as plot devices that explore the narrative contents of the next arc.

The Final Gig should also have an encounter with Promotions, to showcase how this Gig feels "harder" than what the Player Characters are usually accustomed to. It is also better to make its plot-relevant events become important an Arc or two later.

Mission Arcs

As stated previously, it is better to build up a Mission by giving "references" to it in previous Jobs. If the previous arc was a Street Arc, then half of the Jobs there (rounded down) would have to be relevant to the Mission in this Arc. Therefore, it is better to prepare this Mission beforehand.

It is also better to make sure all of your Edgerunners have something relevant to this Mission. It can be something minor or major, but personal affairs along the way can make this Mission feel a bit juicier than before.

Recommended In-Game Day Length of Missions or Downtime after Jobs and Missions

- **1d6 days** if it is an Easy Job/Mission
- **7+1d6 days** if it is a Typical Job/Mission
- **14+1d6 days** if it is a Dangerous Job/Mission

6 Ways of Making Jobs/Missions Related to the Edgerunner(-s)

The Gig can feature one of the six features below.
Since a Mission is on a larger scale, it can have two or more of the features presented below.
Other types of Jobs can have one or more features, up to the GM's discretion.

Roll 1d6 or choose

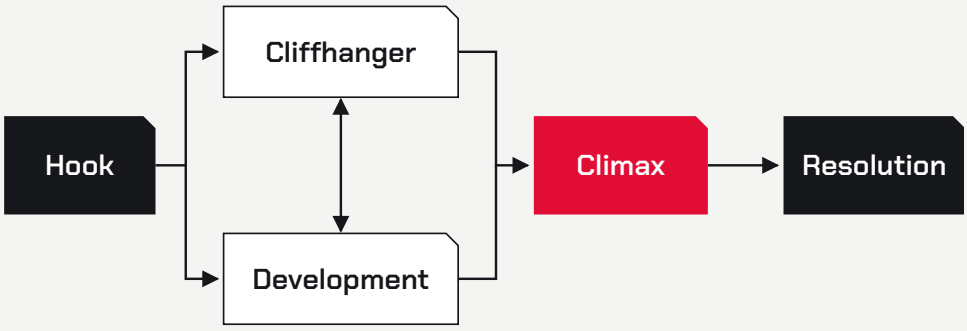
⚀	Make the Job/Mission related to the character's Local Area or Language
⚁	Make the Job/Mission related to the character's backstory/past
⚂	Make the Job/Mission relevant to one of the character's friends/family
⚃	Make the Job/Mission relevant to the Edgerunner's (Tragic) Love Affair
⚄	Make the Job/Mission feature one of the character's enemies
⚅	Make the Job/Mission related to the Edgerunner's Role

Structuring Your Jobs/Missions

Now, page 387 of the Core Rulebook details a lot of the key elements you need when running narratives in the TTRPG. However, I'm sure you have your own personal vision when it comes to making your own stories, as otherwise you wouldn't have taken the GM Role.

The Cyberpunk RED Core Rulebook has something called "Beat Charts" (page 395). They are helpful guidelines that give you an easier time structuring your Narratives, Gigs and Operations. So feel free to use them however you like.

Page 75 of Single Player Mode gives a model and a list of tables for Hooks, Cliffhangers, etc., showing how the Narrative can be structured.



Beat chart structure, redrawn. See Cyberpunk RED Core Rulebook, p. 395, and Single Player Mode, p. 75.

Now, this doesn't mean that this is the only way to structure stuff in Cyberpunk. But it does help a lot with organizing, or with using your creative juices, in the process of making sense of what you're making.

02 Structuring the Opposition of Jobs and Missions

Alright, you got the list of the available types of jobs... How do I fill my opposition?

Well, when deciding how much danger to throw at your players, you need to determine the size of the opposition the PCs will be facing.

The easiest way to do so would be to count the number of Player Characters you will have at the table (let's say, for the sake of argument, that it is 4) and then balance the encounters around that number.

For calculation purposes, when it comes to jobs, throw in:

1 Mook
per 1 Edgerunner

1 Lieutenant
per 2 Edgerunners

1 Mini-Boss
per 3 Edgerunners

1 Boss
per 4 Edgerunners

NET Architectures are interesting. There's no stated rule on when to throw them in, so give it a narrative thought. However, consider this: I'll give my advice on how and when to throw in a NET Architecture, along with other challenges for the Player Characters' Netrunner(-s).

I'll talk about creating/picking NPCs and NET Arches in a different section. For now, keep those numbers in mind.

It is also worth considering whether or not you want to throw in Hardened enemies.

Hardened Enemies are made to oppose Hardened Edgerunners. A Hardened Edgerunner is considered to have 1 of the following:

- A REF of 8 with an Evasion Skill Level of 6 or higher.
- Ability to attack with STAT + Skill + Mod of 15 or higher.
- WILL + BODY of 16 or higher.
- They own a weapon with a value of Luxury or higher.
- A DEX of 8 combined with a MOVE of 8.
- Autofire or Martial Arts Skill Level of 6 or higher.
- Solo Rank 4 or higher.
- They use Interface RED Vol. 5 Inventory.

As you might've guessed, a Hardened Edgerunner is one that is capable of being good in combat.

Now, this is very complicated, so I will help you balance things out around each Job threat level and what you should do when structuring your encounter.

03 Structuring the Difficulty of Jobs

Jobs usually come in three packages, as listed below.

Job types

Job type	What to expect	Pay (per person)
Easy Job	Armed resistance isn't expected, though it is never ruled out	500eb
Typical Job	Armed resistance is expected, and you can prepare for it	1,000eb
Dangerous Job	Overwhelming armed resistance; without heavy preparation, the crew dies	2,000eb

Summarized from the "Doing Jobs" table in the Cyberpunk RED Core Rulebook.

Easy Job

Payout (per person)	**500eb**
Expected Players for Combat	Number equal to the Player Characters present, minus 1 (if there are 4 Players at the table, throw in 3 Mooks)
Hardened Enemies	Dependent on Player Characters. Rounded more toward the non-Hardened side.
Do the Enemies have Role Abilities?	Dependent on Player Characters. If half of the Player Characters (rounded up) are Hardened, then yes.
Suggested NET Architecture Difficulty	1 level lower than the recommended one for the Netrunner(-s), or Basic.
Suggested Demon in the NET Architecture	Imp if the Netrunner's Role Rank is 1–7; otherwise, throw in an Efreet.

Typical Job

Payout (per person)	**1,000eb**
Expected Players for Combat	Number equal to the Player Characters present (if there are 4 Players at the table, throw in 4 Mooks or 2 Lieutenants)
Hardened Enemies	Dependent on Player Characters. **But if 2 non-Hardened Player Characters and 2 Hardened Player Characters fight a Boss, consider the Boss Hardened.**
Do the Enemies have Role Abilities?	Dependent on Player Characters. If half of the Player Characters (rounded down) are Hardened, then yes.
Suggested NET Architecture Difficulty	The recommended one for the Netrunner(-s), or Standard.
Suggested Demon in the NET Architecture	Imp if the Netrunner's Role Rank is 1–3; Efreet if the Netrunner's Role Rank is 4–7; otherwise, throw in a Balron.

Dangerous Job	
Payout (per person)	**2,000eb**
Expected Players for Combat	Number equal to the Player Characters present, plus 1 (if there are 4 Players at the table, throw in 1 Mini-Boss and 2 Mooks)
Hardened Enemies	Dependent on Player Characters. Rounded more toward the Hardened side.
Do the Enemies have Role Abilities?	Yes.
Suggested NET Architecture Difficulty	One Difficulty higher than the recommended one for the Netrunner(-s), or Uncommon.
Suggested Demon in the NET Architecture	Efreet if the Netrunner's Role Rank is 1–3; otherwise, throw in a Balron.

Useful Note

Just because you have one Job does not mean that you have to throw in only one combat encounter. Someone might want to try to mug the Edgerunners on the road or get to the scene after the Edgerunners cleared it.

In this case, you can split the encounter. Let's say it is a Typical Job and 6 PCs are dealing with it: the crew will have two combat encounters instead of one, both of them built around 5 PCs being able to tackle them, instead of 6 PCs.

04 Structuring the Difficulty of Missions

Missions usually come in three packages, as listed below.

Mission types

Mission type	What to expect	Operational Budget (per person)	Mission Pay (per person)
Easy Mission	Organized, armed resistance; no mission is ever truly easy	1,000–5,000eb	3,000–4,000eb
Typical Mission	An entrenched enemy that far outnumbers the crew, offset by the crew's tactical advantages	2,000–7,000eb	4,000–7,000eb
Dangerous Mission	The enemy outnumbers, outclasses and outguns the crew	10,000–30,000eb	6,000–9,000eb

Summarized from "Mission Parameters" in Solo of Fortune 2045 (Interface RED Vol. 5).

Missions can be structured in one of two ways:

Single-Target Missions

Single-Target Missions are rare, but not unheard of, and expect the Edgerunners to tackle a single threat. In that case, just follow the examples of Jobs on structuring the combat encounter, but expect the enemy to be capable of tackling one more PC, or two more PCs if no Edgerunner Opposition is expected (which will be discussed later).

> **Example**
>
> 4 PCs get a Typical Mission to take down a single target. That means that instead of the opposition being capable of tackling 4 PCs, they can tackle 6.

"Room" Missions

Missions usually do not have a single opposition, but are structured to have multiple "rooms" and encounters of opposition, though it is still recommended to balance said rooms based on the Player Count.

Most of the enemy resistance consists of Lieutenants. Mooks are used sparingly.

Every single encounter is Hardened when it comes to the NPC forces, which are guaranteed to have Role Abilities.

If there's a Demon/Netrunner that operates the location of the Mission, then consider them to be a part of every single room.

> **Example**
>
> It is a Dangerous Operation. 4 PCs storm a facility at the front entrance. They are met with 2 Hardened Lieutenants and additional defenses operated by the Demon. The PCs win the encounter, and their Netrunner even defeats the Demon. They push through the facility and now only have to face 2 Hardened Lieutenants.

> **Note**
>
> If you have an uneven number of expected PCs (4 PCs tackling a Dangerous Mission, which expects 5 PCs), you can instead use one PC slot to give to either the Netrunner Opposition or the Special Opposition.

Inventory purchased via the Operational Budget and its leftovers must be returned. Cyberware will be installed free of charge. "Non-refundable" purchases, like therapy, don't need to be refunded, as long as they are relevant to the Operation. Your contact might let you spend the Operational Budget on Lifestyle and Rent, if it fits the mission.

It is better to also have an Edgerunner NPC (who can have LUCK) in opposition to the party and/or a "Special Opposition" that is meant to be the challenge to the party. Both the opposing Edgerunners and the Special Opposition have "Promotions" (which will be discussed later).

Easy Mission

Operational Budget (per person)	**1,000 to 5,000eb**
Mission Pay (per person)	**3,000 to 4,000eb**
Resistance per “Room”	Number equal to the Player Characters present, minus 1 (if there are 4 Players at the table, throw in 1 Hardened Lieutenant and a Demon)
Reinforcements	If a member of the opposition goes down, a Hardened Lieutenant will arrive in 2d6 Rounds to replace them in the attacked “room”.
Suggested NET Architecture Difficulty	1 level lower than the recommended one for the Netrunner(-s), or Basic.
Suggested Demon in the NET Architecture	Imp if the Netrunner’s Role Rank is 1–7; otherwise, throw in an Efreet.

Typical Mission

Operational Budget (per person)	**2,000 to 7,000eb**
Mission Pay (per person)	**4,000 to 7,000eb**
Resistance per “Room”	Number equal to the Player Characters present (if there are 4 Players at the table, throw in 2 Hardened Lieutenants)
Reinforcements	If a member of the opposition goes down, a Hardened Lieutenant will arrive in 1d6 Rounds to replace them in the attacked “room”.
Suggested NET Architecture Difficulty	The recommended one for the Netrunner(-s), or Standard.
Suggested Demon in the NET Architecture	Imp if the Netrunner’s Role Rank is 1–3; Efreet if the Netrunner’s Role Rank is 4–7; otherwise, throw in a Balron.

Dangerous Mission

Operational Budget (per person)	**10,000 to 30,000eb**
Mission Pay (per person)	**6,000 to 9,000eb**
Resistance per “Room”	Number equal to the Player Characters present, plus 1 (if there are 4 Players at the table, throw in 2 Hardened Lieutenants and a Demon)
Reinforcements	If a member of the opposition goes down, a Hardened Lieutenant will arrive in 1d6/2 Rounds (rounded up) to replace them in the attacked “room”.
Suggested NET Architecture Difficulty	One Difficulty higher than the recommended one for the Netrunner(-s), or Uncommon.
Suggested Demon in the NET Architecture	Efreet if the Netrunner’s Role Rank is 1–3; otherwise, throw in a Balron.

05 The “Big Leagues” Difficulty

If your Edgerunners are going through most Jobs/Missions with ease and without much of a sweat, they’re fit for The Big Leagues Difficulty.

What Does It Offer?

- Payout/Operational Budget for all Jobs and Missions is doubled
- The Opposition for Jobs/Missions can tackle one more Edgerunner than expected
- NET Architectures have an additional Demon installed into them
- Recommended In-Game Day Length of Missions or Downtime after Jobs and Missions is doubled

06 Structuring the Opposition for the Netrunner in Jobs/Missions

Determine the Difficulty

The Netrunner Rank is the most important part when structuring the difficulty of the NET Architecture. A Typical Job/Mission would have a NET Architecture equal/close to the Netrunner’s Role Rank.

If your Netrunner is of Rank 8 or higher, it is easier to throw in an additional Demon into the Architecture or to introduce a Netrunner threat alongside a Demon to make the NET Combat for them more challenging.

NET Architecture difficulty

	Basic	Standard	Uncommon	Advanced
Password / File / Control Node DV	DV6	DV8	DV10	DV12
Interface of a Netrunner with a fighting chance	2	4	6	8
Interface of a Netrunner who might not survive to the bottom	N/A	2 or less	4 or less	6 or less

Data from the Cyberpunk RED Core Rulebook.

Determine the Floor Number

Although you can traditionally roll 3d6 to determine NET Architecture length, you can also refer to the expectations of how long each NET Architecture should be.

NET Architecture size and cost

Number of floors	Maximum Control Nodes	Portable?	Cost per floor
3 to 6	2	Yes	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
7 to 12	3	No	5,000eb (Luxury)
13 to 18	N/A	No	10,000eb (Super Luxury)

Data from “Buying a NET Architecture” in the Cyberpunk RED Core Rulebook.

NET Architectures with 3 to 6 floors are usually reserved for portable items of high importance, like laptops; meanwhile, NET Arches with 13 to 18 floors are worth saving for Megabuildings and such.

When to Throw a Demon

It is better to throw in a Demon if your Netrunner is considered to be a Hardened Edgerunner. Recommended Demons per Job are stated earlier. For Missions, if, for whatever reason, you want to throw in a NET Architecture but no Enemy Netrunners to control/patrol it, you can add an additional Demon.

When to Throw an Enemy Netrunner

For Jobs, make the Netrunner part of the expected enemy forces. For Missions, make a separate “control room” where the Netrunner may operate.

07 How to Make Fun NPCs

While not every single NPC needs a description or STAT/Skills/Inventory block, it is nice to have certain characters with defining features and characteristics.

Making Descriptions for NPCs

Core Requirements

Steps 2 and 3 can be done in either order. Step 3 is also non-mandatory.

1. Figure out a general theme/idea of an NPC (Arasaka Assassin, Shady Fixer, etc.)
2. Use Single Player Mode tables to generate a short description of their appearance
3. Non-mandatory: Find a reference image, even if it isn’t identical to the expected result, as long as it closely resembles it
4. Give the NPC a defining character feature that makes them stand out (a large scar, unique fashionware, etc.)

Keywords

You can additionally use **Keywords** from **Single Player Mode** to help you with NPC Generation:

Nationality and Spoken Language	
Gender (Male/Female/Nonbinary)	
First Name	Can be edited to fit a desired cultural origin, or changed to fit the theme/setting better; use Verbs/Nouns/Adjectives (VNAs) for assistance. It's better to pick either one verb, one noun or one adjective.
Handle	VNAs can be used for more creative approaches to established Handles; Handles are also good for special weapons and such.
Last Name	Combination of First Name, Handle and other real-world references.
NPC Moods	Straightforward, but can also be edited to fit the NPC better. Using VNAs is advised as well.
Role	Straightforward. If something unorthodox is dropped instead, consider re-rolling or using two Roles to make the character a bit more unique.
Fashion, Hair and Eye Color	Straightforward, but can also be edited depending on the choice of character. VNAs can help with unique fashion choices or with adding a unique trinket.
Fashionware	Can be added or not, depending on the NPC.
Choice of Weapons	1 – Melee, 2 – Firearms, 3 – Mix.
Unique Trinket/Feature	Up to the GM's interpretation. All of the previously listed info can help. VNAs are recommended.

Description Format

It's better to go in the following format, in order:

1. The NPC's profession (aka their Role(-s))
2. Physical appearance, hairstyle and emotional expressions
3. Choice of clothing
4. Visible weapons, firearms
5. Unique feature/characteristic

NPC Description Example

Example of Solomon Reed:

Solomon Reed	NPC description
1 Role	The agent of the state and a simple office worker from Langley.
2 Appearance	Despite his age and the miserable look on his face, Reed's body is in perfect, healthy shape, and he works with the energy of a young intern who just entered his favorite field of work.
3 Clothing	Despite wearing businesswear, he likes to keep it very old-fashioned. The attire has a very strong "dad" look to it. Even his short black hair is nice and inoffensive, almost like he prefers going to the same barber on a monthly, if not weekly, basis.
4 Weapons	He's in possession of no firearms, at least not in the traditional sense. The men in suits walking around him provide more than enough protection.
5 Unique feature	Every day for work, he likes to pick "funny ties": very unprofessional ones that would be considered a dress-code violation. He sometimes likes to think this is his way of "fighting the system" and still being in control of his choices.

Making NPC Sheets

The guidelines for making NPCs are in Danger Gal Dossier, page 150. It is a short read, but I humbly recommend reading through most of the content presented, as it will help you out with making NPCs fast and easy.

> **In the book**
>
> Danger Gal Dossier, p. 150 covers the last steps of NPC creation and the NPC Templates for Mooks, Lieutenants, Mini-Bosses and Bosses: STAT and Skill point budgets, suggested HP and SP, important Combat and Non-Combat Skill Bases, Gear and Cyberware budgets, and what to add to Harden each one.

However, if you just want to grab an NPC straight out of the oven, Danger Gal Dossier has A LOT of Character Sheets.

But... psst... a little secret... you can ease up on Skill Points.

Combat and Non-Combat Skill Bases are already listed. So go forth.

Now, I won't bore you with what Danger Gal Dossier recommends for NPC Creation, and will actually give you some of my own notes.

About Gear and Cyberware

It is entirely up to you how you make and dress your little NPCs, HOWEVER, there's no "official" ruling that NPCs cannot have certain items.

Personally speaking, I don't like giving Speedware to Mooks and Lieutenants, especially when it comes to Quick and Dirty combat, unless they are some kind of Edgerunner enemies who are meant to challenge the group. But things can change depending on how your group tackles Mooks and Lieutenants.

Additionally, I don't like giving CEMK and Interface RED Vol. 5 gear to NPCs unless they are in a specific time and place where that gear would be commonplace, or where they would have a reason to have it for combat/narrative reasons (like being Hardened enemies). But feel free to give it to the enemies, if you find it an appropriate type of gear to give.

Experimental Sandevistan is also "fine" to give to Hardened Bosses, but it is better saved up for combatants who are meant to feel "extra".

Berserk Implants are also better saved for Mini-Bosses or Bosses, as NPCs become very challenging to kill.

Roles for NPCs and What to Do with Them

Giving your NPCs Roles of **Solo / Exec / Lawman / Nomad** is pretty easy. Just follow what utilities are given by the Core Rulebook as if they were regular PCs. Execs also do not need to roll for Loyalty to their Team Members, unless you think it is important for whatever reason. They are in combat, so it would be natural for the Team Members to assist in combat, because it is a life-or-death situation for them.

Other Roles are good for making combat-related stuff too, though you'll have to put some effort into making them valuable.

Rockers roll a single Charismatic Impact Skill Check. If they pass a DV8, they can add a single Mook to an encounter. If they pass a DV10, they can add either two Mooks or one Lieutenant to the encounter. If they pass a DV12, they can add 2 Lieutenants or a single Mini-Boss to an encounter. To Harden them or not is up to you. But if a Rocker is Hardened, I'd argue their posse is also Hardened. If the Rocker rolls nothing? Do what you think is appropriate.

> (If you make a Mission, make a few changes. If they pass a DV8, add 1 Lieutenant who follows the Rocker around. If they pass a DV10, add two Lieutenants or one Mini-Boss who is always close to the Rocker. If they pass a DV12, add 2 Mini-Bosses or 1 Boss who follows the Rocker. All are Hardened, because every single enemy in the Mission is considered Hardened.)

Netrunners benefit GREATLY from a NET Architecture in 2045, so remember to always add one to some extent (keep in mind that portable NET Arches can exist). If it is a CEMK Netrunner, there's no need for a NET Arch. They can hack enemies.

Techs can Fabricate/Upgrade/Invent items without time constraints. However, they are still restricted by budget, and if they fail to make something? They fail. No retries (unless they can somehow spend LUCK). Consider the Gear Budget to be the budget they spend on materials.

Medtechs. If they have points in Surgery, roll a Surgery Skill Check once. Depending on the DV they beat, they get a single piece of Cyberware of the respective price category for free. If they have Pharmaceuticals, follow the rules for

fabricating Pharmaceuticals, including paying for materials, but without any time constraints. Cryobag-operating Medtechs are better saved for when they can actually "save" someone in their respective group, or for flavor.

Medias. Roll a Passive Rumor Skill Check once to determine what they know about the opposition. It can make for interesting counterplay to the party's strength.

Fixers. Roll Haggle to get discounts on goods.

These are all suggestions, btw. If you have any other ideas, go for them.

Base Facedown for Each NPC Type

NPC type	Reputation
Mooks and Hardened Mooks	1
Lieutenants and Hardened Lieutenants	3
Mini-Bosses / Hardened Mini-Bosses	4
Bosses	5
Hardened Bosses	6

08 Promotions

Interface RED Volumes 2–3 have DLC for Hardened Mooks, Lieutenants and Mini-Bosses. If you consider them "not strong enough", you can "Promote" them by giving them certain bonuses.

This is my rendition of the Promotions idea, but relegated to Mini-Bosses or Bosses, as I believe Promotions should be extremely rare and saved only for "special" encounters, like the ending of an Arc.

Promotion Number

How the "Promotion" number works:

- Promotions are reserved for buffing enemies.
- Promotions are only given to Hardened Enemies.
- For the final Job of the first Street Arc or for the first Mission Arc, give the opposition 1 Promotion.
- If the crew succeeds in the confrontation with Promotions, even with casualties, raise that number by 1.
- If the crew "destroys" the confrontation with Promotions, double the current number.
- If the crew did poorly or were very close to defeat, either keep the current number, lower it by one or raise it by one. Up to your vibes.

How and to Whom to Give Promotions

For NPC Groups:

- Each NPC present in the Opposition gets the same number of Promotions (Example: There are 11 Promotions, and there's a Hardened Boss and two Hardened Mooks. The Hardened Boss gets 11 Promotions, the first Mook gets 11 Promotions and the second Mook gets 11 Promotions).
- Now, if you don't want to bother with giving Promotions to Mooks (why would you? They're meant to suck most of the time), you can give the Promotions that all NPCs would get in the encounter to the beefiest NPC instead (Example: There are 11 Promotions, and there's a Hardened Boss and two Hardened Mooks. The Hardened Boss gets 11 (from the Boss) + 11/4 × 2 (due to the two Mooks being 4 times weaker than a Boss; the number is rounded up) = 17).

For an Encounter against a Single NPC:

1. See the type of Job/Mission your Players are on (let's say a Dangerous Job).
2. Count the expected Player Count that the opposition is supposed to tackle (we have 6 Players, which means the Opposition must tackle 7 Players, based on the fact that it is a Dangerous Job).
3. Select your NPC for the encounter (most likely a Hardened Boss, so it already covers 4 Players).
4. Find the number of Players the NPC cannot tackle (since it is a Hardened Boss, that means it can tackle 4 Players. The expected opposition is 7 Players, so it lacks the strength to tackle 3 Players).
5. Keep adding the total Promotion number X times, where X is the number of Players it is lacking against (if we have 11 Promotions, that means we add that number 3 additional times, which is essentially 11 + 11 + 11 + 11 = 44 Promotions).

Notes for Missions (aka Operations):

- It is better to give Promotions to ONLY the Big "Room" of Opposition and the Opposing Edgerunner Crew. These are meant to be challenging encounters that differ from the usual way combat is supposed to flow.
- If you want to have only one big opposition instead, just consider the encounter being capable of tackling an additional player.

How and When to Give NPCs Promotions

After the crew finishes an "Arc" or an intended, particularly hard encounter, it is safe to do the following:

- Increase the Promotion number by 1 or 2.

How to Spend Promotions

- 1 Promotion: 500eb or less / 1,000eb or less of Gear or Cyberware for a Mini-Boss / Boss.
- 1, 2, 10, 20 is the best way to calculate the increasing Difficulty of certain Upgrades. If leveling a Skill from >10 to 17 or 18 is 1 Difficulty, then getting a Base 16 for a Skill is 2 Difficulty. 20 is always the max, so if you already paid 20, the next payment is also 20.

- Rank Increases go as follows: purchase half of the recommended Rank (up to the available maximum) or increase the maximum Rank by 1. Each time Ranks are purchased, follow the 1, 2, 10, 20 Principle (Example: A Rank 8 Solo wants to multiclass into Exec. Pay 1 Promotion to give them Exec 4. Pay another 2 Promotions to give them Exec 8. Now he wants to ensure his Solo Rank is at the max. Pay 10 Promotions to give him Rank 9 Solo. Then pay 20 Promotions to give him Rank 10 Solo).
- x2 Skills take double Promotions as well, so leveling an x2 Skill to 17 or 18 is 2 Promotions, or getting it to Base 16 is 4 Promotions.
- If you create a custom item, the number of Promotions to invent it is equal to the price category of the item. The same goes for creating the item as well. Keep in mind that at least half the price goes to the Tech and the Fixer:

```
Total Item Price =
  Materials Price for Fabrication / Time Price for Invention
  + Half of the Fabrication / Invention Price, paid to the Tech for
    their Service
  + Half of the Fabrication / Invention Price, paid to the Fixer
```

  If your NPC can somehow lessen that price, either by being a Tech or by having Fixer, Rockerboy or Streetwise Connections, feel free to lessen the Promotion price.
- ACPAs count as Gear Budget.
- To raise Reputation by 1 point, spend 1, 2, 10, 20 Promotions.
- Make a custom FBC Body: DV29 Cybertech or 10 Promotions.

09 Structuring Boss Fights and/or Cyberpsychos

As much fun as it is to make a Boss Fight with 40+ pieces of chrome implanted in their body, it is not fun on the receiving end for the party to fight against a particularly tough chrome-junkie who has somehow still kept their ability to make rational decisions.

Here I will propose respective enemy behavior based on their remaining Empathy.

The Morale table from Single Player Mode will be important for this. It is important to note that the "Lost to violence/Fully dedicated" mentality should have no "End Fight" rolls. It doesn't make sense that a character who wishes to fight tooth and nail would give up at some point.

Morale

Mentality	Typical examples	End Fight	Keep Fighting
Lost to violence / Fully dedicated	Raging cyberpsycho, ganger on combat drugs, Boss making a last stand	1–2	3–10
Experienced combatant with a mission or a death wish	Hardened ganger or elite security, Mini-Boss	1–4	5–10
Trained combatant	Experienced ganger or regular security, Lieutenant	1–6	7–10
Inexperienced combatant	Newbie ganger or security, Hardened Mook	1–8	9–10
Unsure streetrat	Cannon fodder, Mook	1–9	10

Data from the Morale table in Single Player Mode.

Empathy of 0 or Greater

The enemy still has a mental capacity to feel empathy for others and is more than capable of caring about others and themselves, the higher their empathy is.

Compensating for their lack of a lot of chrome with a rational mind, the enemy has a good understanding of where and when they are, and may choose to use strategies that won't require them and/or their group to be in the line of fire.

An enemy with borderline dissociative disorder most likely does not harbor much sympathy for their group or subordinates, not realizing the danger they throw themselves into. However, they may choose to end the conflict if they manage to understand the severity of the situation they are in.

The lower the NPC's Empathy is, the less likely they are to surrender. The Hare Psychopathy Checklist will also be greatly important in determining weaker aspects of the enemy that the crew can capitalize on.

Extreme Cyberpsychosis

Extreme Cyberpsychosis enemies are much more dangerous in terms of the chrome they're sporting, but much more predictable.

They will, in order:

1. Direct their attention to a character, or a specific group of characters, who caused them the most emotional distress
2. Follow a direct command to a T
3. Attack the enemy who has done the most damage to them
4. Attack the enemy who attacked them last

Raging Extreme Cyberpsychosis

Either through Street Drugs or with Cyberware like the Berserk Implant, the user becomes very aggressive and becomes more akin to an animal than a human when it comes to attacking others or defending themselves.

They will, in order:

1. Attack an enemy who actively tries to get their attention
2. Attack an enemy who caused them a lot of emotional distress
3. Attack the enemy that is closest to them
4. Attack the enemy who damaged them last

A Abbreviations & Sources

1d6, 2d6, 3d6	Dice notation: roll that many six-sided dice and add them up. 7+1d6 adds 7 to the roll; 1d6/2 halves it.
ACPA	Assisted Combat Power Armor, from Solo of Fortune 2045 (Interface RED Vol. 5).
Arc	A run of connected Gigs (Street Arc), or a Mission built up over earlier Jobs (Mission Arc).
CEMK	Cyberpunk: Edgerunners Mission Kit.
DV	Difficulty Value: the number a Skill Check has to beat.
eb	Eurobucks, the setting's currency.
FBC	Full Body Conversion: a complete cyborg body.
Facedown	A test of nerve between two characters before a fight, rolled with COOL and Reputation.
GM	Gamemaster.
Hardened	Tougher versions of the NPC tiers, made for crews built for combat.
Mook, Lieutenant, Mini-Boss, Boss	The four NPC threat tiers, from cannon fodder to an enemy who can take on the whole crew.
NET Architecture	A network a Netrunner breaks into floor by floor, defended by Demons such as the Imp, Efreet and Balron. Also shortened to NET Arch.
NPC / PC	Non-player character / player character.
Role, Role Rank	A character's profession (Solo, Netrunner, Tech, Medtech, Media, Exec, Lawman, Fixer, Nomad, Rockerboy) and the rank of its Role Ability, from 1 to 10.
Skill Base	STAT + Skill Level: what a character adds to the d10 on a Skill Check.
Speedware	Reflex-boosting cyberware, such as the Sandevistan.
STAT	One of a character's ten core attributes. This guide uses REF (Reflexes), DEX (Dexterity), MOVE (Movement), WILL (Willpower), BODY, LUCK and EMP (Empathy).
TTRPG	Tabletop role-playing game.
VNA	Verbs, Nouns and Adjectives: the word tables in Single Player Mode.
x2 Skill	A Skill that costs double to improve.

Sources Referenced

- Cyberpunk RED Core Rulebook (R. Talsorian Games, 2020)
- Interface RED Volume 2 (2023): Hardened Mooks, Hardened Lieutenants
- Danger Gal Dossier (2023)
- Interface RED Volume 3 (2024): Hardened Mini Bosses
- Cyberpunk: Edgerunners Mission Kit (2024)
- Single Player Mode (2025)
- Interface RED Volume 5 (2026): Solo of Fortune 2045